



Gaming phones (under ₹30,000)

Supercharged gaming

Smartphone gaming is one of the fastest-growing industries and there was enough evidence to prove the same in 2021. There already exist a number of smartphone games like Fortnite and Call of Duty: Mobile that have become hugely popular over the last few years. However, getting the best experience out of these games require nothing less than the best phone for gaming and the industry has responded with a new breed of gaming smartphones. However, what if you are on a budget, and still want a phone that can provide great gaming experiences? Well, fret not because this year saw some really good gaming phones under the ₹30,000 price point, built from the ground up for gaming. For this category, we tested three phones – the Poco F3 GT, Realme GT Master Edition and the iQOO Z5. While there are points of differentiation between them, all three do have a few things in common – lots of RAM and storage, a large, vibrant display with fast touch response and long battery life. Read on to know our Digit Zero1 pick for the winner, runner-up and best value for money buy from the segment.

Winner: Poco F3 GT

The Poco F3 GT is a special device from the house of Poco. It packs a lot of powerful hardware and offers some interesting gaming first features. While the Poco F3 GT is not explicitly marketed by Poco as a gaming smartphone, it is in essence just that. Proof of it is the presence of physical gaming triggers, which honestly is one of the most interesting things about the Poco F3 GT and something that also helped it win the crown in this segment. These are maglev triggers that offer nice and tactile feedback, and as we found out, are quite helpful if you plan on spending a good chunk of your time playing heavy duty games on the Poco F3 GT. Apart from this, the Poco F3 GT also scored well in our CPU and GPU tests, and in the process ensured that it emerged as the winner in the segment.



Poco F3 GT

Price: ₹28,999



realme GT Master Edition

Price: ₹25,999

Runner Up: Realme GT master edition

Realme GT Master Edition emerged as the runner-up in the segment, but only by a small margin. The Realme GT Master Edition promises great gaming experiences because it brings with it other hardware and software features that improve the experience of playing games and running resource-intensive applications on the device. The phone comes with a 120 Hz AMOLED display with support for 100% coverage of the DCI-P3 colour gamut. It also supports a 360 Hz touch sampling rate which is not the fastest in the business but is still pretty good for a phone in this price range. At the heart of the device is a powerful Snapdragon 778G chipset, which helps the device provide an almost flawless experience with games running like a breeze on it.



iQOO Z5

Price: ₹23,990

Best Buy: iQOO Z5

The iQOO Z5 is the winner for the crown of the best buy in this particular category, and understandably so! It scored big on CPU and GPU performance and performed well in real-life gaming scenarios and was generally impressive in its overall performance. Powered by the Snapdragon 778G, the iQOO Z5 offers stable peaks and as a result, good thermals as well. All this coupled with the aggressive price point that iQOO has priced the device at, the Z5 automatically becomes a no-brainer.

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